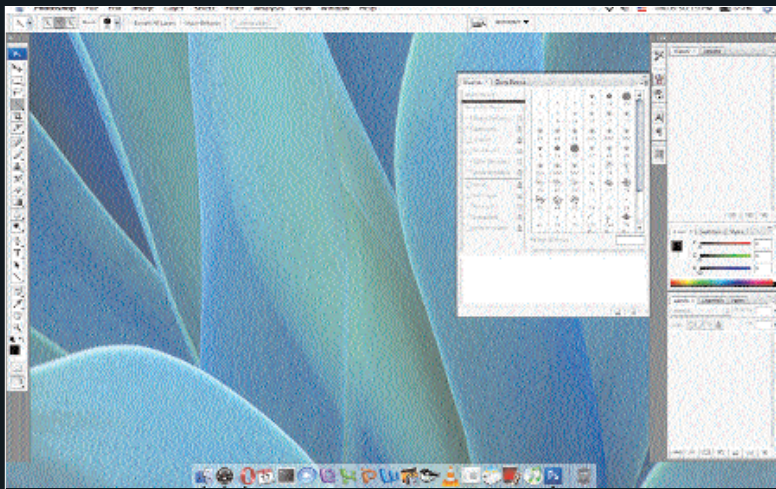




The new interface becomes more manageable without losing its old-school usability

edge of the screen un-hides them, so you always have plenty of space in which to work.

Fun With Selections

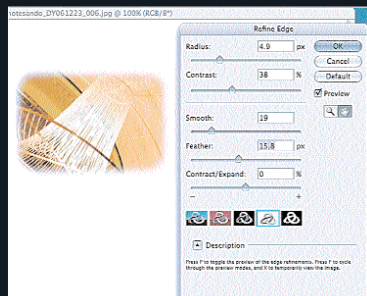
CS3 introduces the new Quick Selection Tool—a crazy mix of the Magic Wand and Magnetic Lasso. It lets you “paint” your selection on areas with the same colour, automatically stopping at the edges. It’s replaced the Magic Wand as



The Quick Selection tool is fast, and mostly precise, making selections much easier

the default tool when you hit [W], though the latter is also there should you need it. The Quick Selection does tend to get a little over-enthusiastic at times, and we’d have appreciated a “Tolerance” parameter to tweak; nevertheless, even recovering from its selection errors is simple, and we hope to see more improvements in updates and point releases (if there are any).

Right up to CS2, if you wanted to Feather, Expand, or Contract your selection, you’d have to go to the Select menu, enter a parameter, and guess. CS3 eliminates this with Refine Edges ([Ctrl] + [Alt] + [R]), which lets you tweak these parameters and watch the effects on-the-fly. Brilliant time-saver, this.



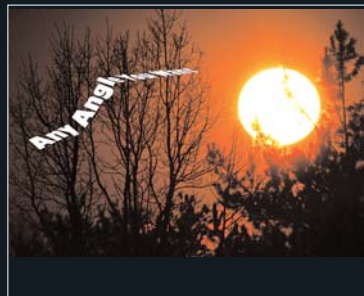
Edit selections with incredible ease using Refine Edges

Old-World Charm

Converting images to black and white is now much more powerful than plain old Convert To Grayscale or Desaturate. The new Black & White image adjustment layer lets you tweak how each channel will look when the image is converted—you can make a sky white by dragging the Blues slider to the right, make reds appear black, and adjust tinting in the same dialog. You can now take boring greyscale images—night scenes, for example—and add a bit of drama to them.

The New Vanishing Point

When it was introduced with CS2, the Vanishing Point filter let you paint on walls and buildings in perfect perspective. However, after drawing a Vanishing Point plane, you could only make planes perpendicular to it—very cumbersome if the surfaces you wanted to paint on weren’t perpendicular. With the new Vanishing Point, you can specify an angle as soon as you tear off a plane, giving you a lot more flexibility. It’s still a tricky tool to use, though—read our *Fast Track to Photoshop* for a tutorial.



Angular surfaces galore with the new Vanishing Point

The Flavours Of Photoshop

Photoshop CS3 Standard

The Standard edition is a direct substitute for Photoshop CS2, and is aimed at graphics professionals. It has the same features you saw in the public beta. You’ll find it in the Creative Suite 3 Standard editions.

Photoshop CS3 Extended

This one’s for people whose demands are a little higher than that of your average design pro. Photoshop Extended features more complex image analysis tools for medical professionals, architects and so on, and a bunch of really nifty features for graphic artists as well. You’ll find it in the Creative Suite 3 Premium editions.

Photoshop Lightroom

What started out as just Adobe Lightroom is now part of the Photoshop family, built for professional and amateur photographers alike. Lightroom is all about getting the most out of your raw photos.

Photoshop Elements

This is a cheaper, lighter version of Photoshop for the consumer who wants a lot more than basic image editing. Photoshop Elements gives you features that form Photoshop’s core, balancing the requirements of the professional and the Average Joe.



We converted this (very tricky) image to greyscale, and had a go at another copy with the Black & White adjustment. Getting the same result with Levels and Curves would have taken a lot more than the ten seconds it took us for the Black & White